The professional's recipe box

# 10 prompts worth keeping on file

Copy-paste recipes for managers, HR, sales, analysts & ops. Each with ingredients, method and a taste test.



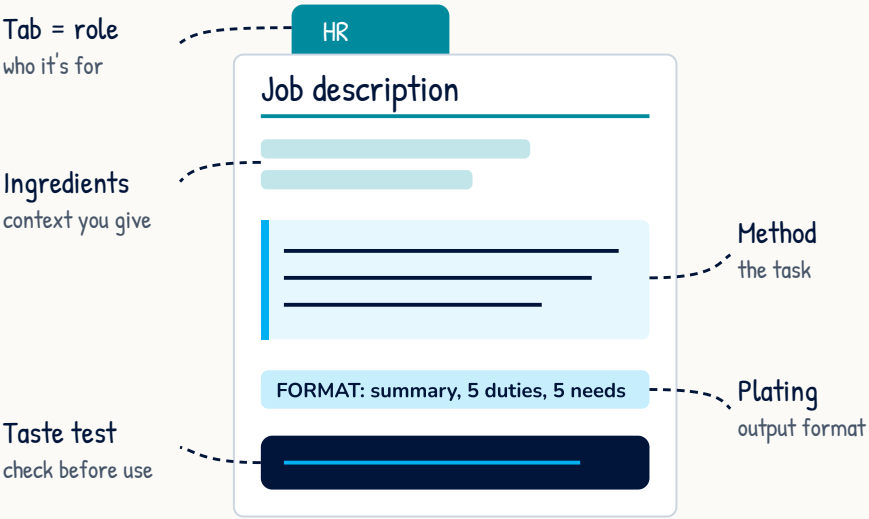


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Read me first

# What's a prompt library & why keep one?

A **prompt library** is a small set of tested prompts your team reuses, like recipe cards. Same quality every time, faster onboarding, nobody starts from a blank box.



Index

# What's in the box

5 role dividers, 2 recipes each. Fill the [brackets] with your own details.

## Manager

- 1:1 prep questions #01
- Weekly status update #02

## HR

- Job description #03
- Policy explainer FAQ #04

## Sales

- Discovery call prep #05
- Follow-up email #06

## Analyst

- Explain the data #07
- Exec summary of a report #08

## Ops

- SOP draft #09
- Root-cause (5 Whys) #10

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Manager

# 1:1 prep questions

#01

SERVES: MANAGERS | PREP: 2 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] Notes from your last 1:1
- [ ] Their current goals
- [ ] One thing you're unsure about

**PLATED AS: NUMBERED LIST**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> You're my coaching partner. Here are notes from my last 1:1 with [name] and their goals: [paste]. Suggest 5 open questions for this week, one about wellbeing.

Swap it: prep a skip-level or a career chat.

**Taste test before serving:** cut anything that sounds scripted. Ask in your own words.

Manager

# Weekly status update

#02

SERVES: MANAGERS | PREP: 3 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] Your rough notes for the week
- [ ] Who reads it (e.g. director)
- [ ] Word limit

**PLATED AS: WINS / RISKS / ASK**

WINS

RISKS

ASK

## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> Act as a chief of staff. Turn my notes into a status update for [audience]: 3 wins, 2 risks, 1 ask. Under 120 words. Notes: [paste]

Swap it: a monthly board update.

**Taste test before serving:** every line must match your notes. No invented progress.

HR

# Job description

#03

SERVES: HR, HIRING LEADS | PREP: 5 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] Role title and team
- [ ] 3–5 real must-haves
- [ ] Your tone of voice

PLATED AS: 3-PART DOC



## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

You're an HR partner. Write a job description for [role] with these must-haves: [list]. Plain, inclusive language. Sections: summary, 5 duties, 5 requirements.

↳ Swap it: an internal job posting.

**Taste test before serving:** remove any requirement you can't justify. Hiring manager signs off.

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HR

# Policy explainer FAQ

#04

SERVES: HR, PEOPLE OPS | PREP: 3 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] The policy text
- [ ] Who it's for (new joiners)
- [ ] Questions people really ask

**PLATED AS: 5 FAQS**




## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> Explain this policy to new joiners in plain English: [paste policy]. Write 5 FAQs with 2-line answers. Flag anything ambiguous.

Swap it: a benefits or expenses guide.

**Taste test before serving:** check every answer against the real policy before sharing.

Sales

# Discovery call prep

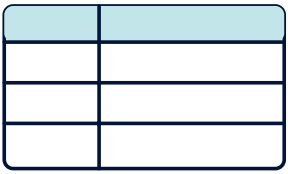
#05

SERVES: SALES, ACCOUNT LEADS | PREP: 4 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] Public info about the prospect
- [ ] What you sell, in one line
- [ ] Their industry

PLATED AS: TABLE



## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> You're a sales coach. From this public info on [company]: [paste], list 3 likely business problems and 5 discovery questions. Use a table.

Swap it: prep for a renewal or upsell call.

**Taste test before serving:** AI may guess. Confirm facts on their website first.

Sales

# Follow-up email

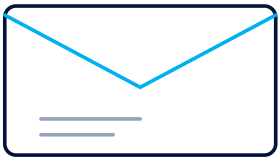
#06

SERVES: SALES, CLIENT TEAMS | PREP: 2 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] Your call notes
- [ ] The agreed next step
- [ ] The client's name and role

**PLATED AS: SHORT EMAIL**



## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> Write a follow-up email to [client] after today's call. Key points: [notes]. Next step: [step]. Under 100 words, friendly, one clear ask.

Swap it: a polite chaser when they go quiet.

**Taste test before serving:** check every name, date and price. Read it aloud once.

Analyst

# Explain the data

#07

SERVES: ANALYSTS, FINANCE | PREP: 5 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] An anonymised table or export
- [ ] The question you need answered
- [ ] Time period covered

**PLATED AS: BULLETS + TRENDS**



## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> You're a data analyst. Here's a table: [paste anonymised data]. Describe 3 trends and 2 anomalies, and say what extra data would confirm each.

Swap it: survey results or NPS comments.

**Taste test before serving:** recompute the key numbers yourself. AI maths can slip.

Analyst

# Exec summary of a report

#08

SERVES: ANALYSTS, STRATEGY | PREP: 3 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] The full report
- [ ] Who decides (e.g. CFO)
- [ ] The decision on the table

PLATED AS: HEADLINE + 3




## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> Summarise this report for a busy executive: [paste]. Give a 1-line headline, 3 bullets and 1 recommended decision. Cite page numbers.

Swap it: a 40-page vendor proposal.

**Taste test before serving:** open every cited page. Make sure the quote is really there.

Ops

# SOP draft

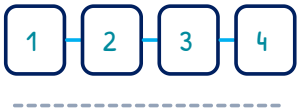
#09

SERVES: OPS, TEAM LEADS | PREP: 5 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] The steps as you do them today
- [ ] Who owns each step
- [ ] Where it usually goes wrong

**PLATED AS: NUMBERED STEPS**




## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

> You're an operations lead. Turn these steps into an SOP: [steps]. Include purpose, numbered steps, an owner per step and common mistakes.

Swap it: an onboarding checklist for new hires.

**Taste test before serving:** walk through it with the person who actually does the job.

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Ops

# Root-cause (5 Whys)

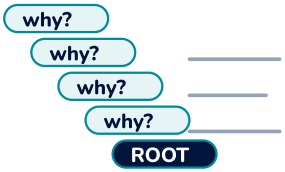
#10

SERVES: OPS, SUPPORT LEADS | PREP: 4 MIN

## INGREDIENTS (CONTEXT TO GIVE)

- [ ] What happened, and when
- [ ] Impact on customers or team
- [ ] What you've already ruled out

**PLATED AS: 5 WHYS CHAIN**




## METHOD (COPY & PASTE)

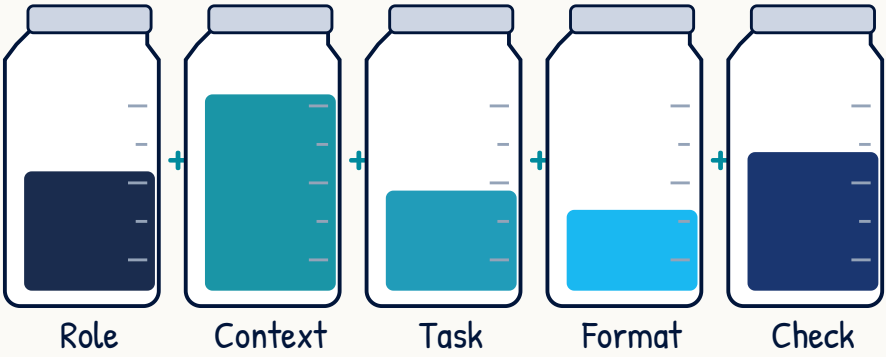
> Here's an incident: [description]. Run a 5 Whys analysis and suggest 3 preventive actions. Ask me questions first if anything is unclear.

Swap it: a recurring customer complaint.

**Taste test before serving:** treat the causes as hypotheses. Verify with the team.

The master recipe

# Every card uses the same 5 ingredients




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Role** | Who should it act as? | "You're an HR partner" |
| **Context** | What does it need to know? | notes, goals, audience |
| **Task** | What exactly to do? | "Suggest 5 questions" |
| **Format** | What shape is the output? | table, 3 bullets, <100 words |
| **Check** | How will you verify it? | facts, numbers, tone |

**Missing an ingredient?** End any prompt with "Ask me what else you need to know."

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Same dish, two ways

# Bland prompt vs seasoned prompt

× BLAND

~~"Write a job ad."~~



✗ no role

✗ no context

✗ no format

✗ no check

Generic tone. Made-up perks. Hours of rework.

✓ SEASONED

You're an HR partner. We're a 40-person logistics firm hiring a data analyst who must know SQL and Excel. Write the job ad in 3 sections, under 250 words. List anything you assumed.

ROLE CONTEXT TASK FORMAT CHECK

Result: a usable first draft, first time.

Example prompt, illustrative company.

Kitchen rules

# Keep the box fresh




## WHERE TO KEEP IT

Shared doc | Team wiki | Pinned post

**House rule:** only paste confidential data into tools your company has approved.

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Cheatsheet

# Your 10-card prompt box

01 1:1 prep questions
02 Weekly status update
03 Job description
04 Policy explainer FAQ
05 Discovery call prep
06 Follow-up email
07 Explain the data
08 Exec summary of a report
09 SOP draft
10 Root-cause (5 Whys)

**THE MASTER RECIPE**

Role + Context + Task + Format + Check

1. Copy the card
2. Fill [brackets]
3. Taste test

Manager HR Sales Analyst Ops

Save this box · repost for your team

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